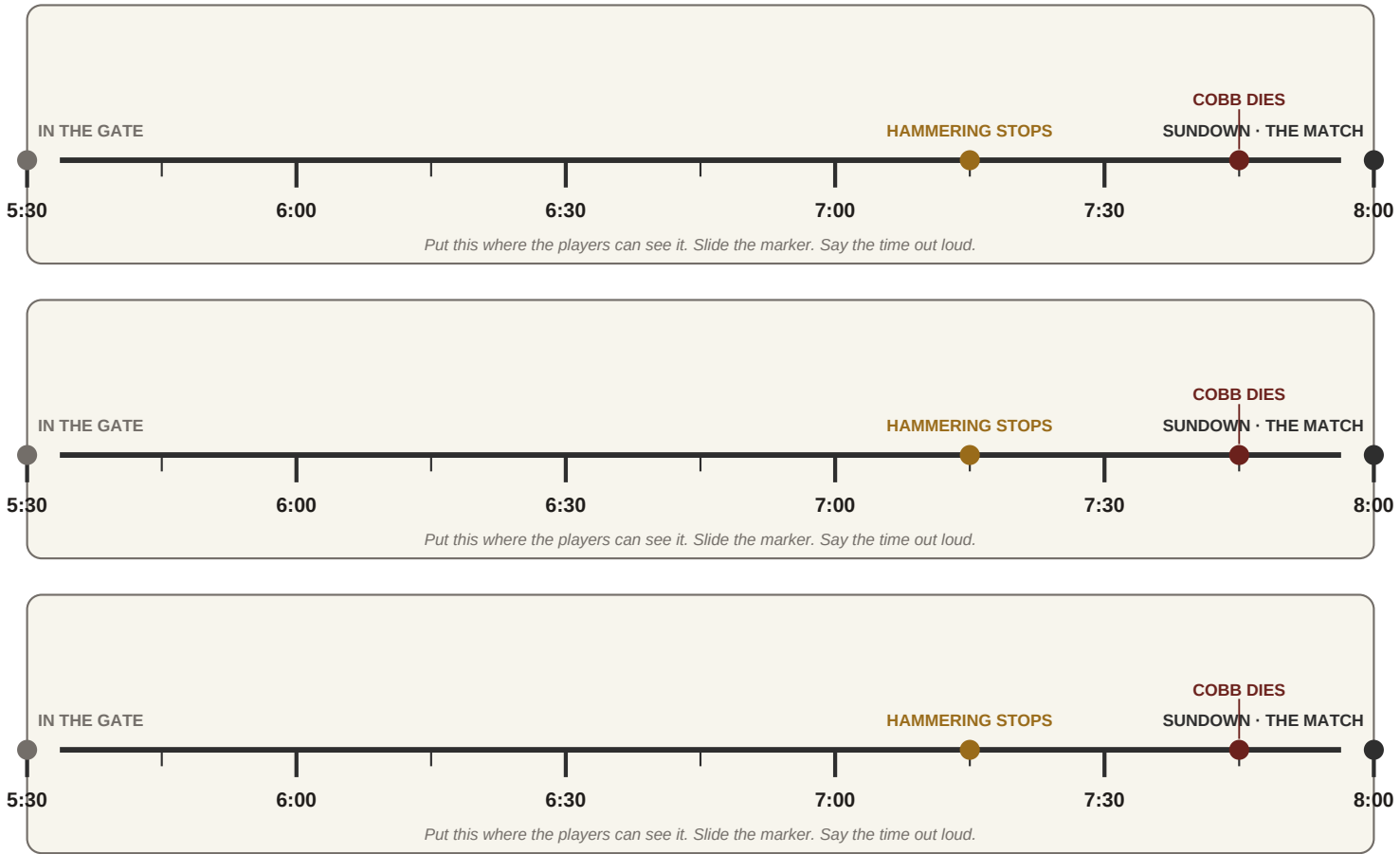
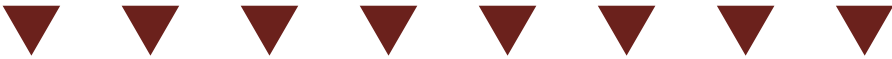




MARKERS — cut out, fold, sit one on the line



WHAT EACH BEAT MEANS

- 5:30** Party inside the gate. Yard working, whipping post active, ring half-built. Vaskar is told a buyer has arrived within a minute.
- ~6:00** Vaskar receives them in the Hall. Courteous. Lies for ten minutes. Cobb is in that building.
- 6:30–7:15** The party's window. Pens, stock, Denrick, Corvant, Anselm, the yard.
- 7:15** Hammering stops. Ring finished. Off-duty Ironwake men wake and drift out. Cobb's interrogation goes quiet — Vaskar has decided he is empty.
- 7:45** Vaskar leaves the office for the arena. COBB DIES HERE if nobody reached him.
- 8:00** Sundown. The match. Every eye on the ring. Anselm's signal lands here.
- after** Vaskar's move on Ysabel — only if all three conditions hold.

Anything that keeps Vaskar in his office keeps Cobb breathing.

A buyer to receive, a price to haggle, an alarm to answer, a noblewoman to be courteous to. Ysabel's cover story is a life-support machine for a man the party has never met, and they will never know it.

THE HOUR

WHAT THEY'VE LEARNED

don't re-reveal · don't contradict

- ☐ Elizabeth and Rowan were brought here
- ☐ Elizabeth died of the fever, days after
- ☐ Rowan was cleaned up and sold on
- ☐ The buyer's name — BARNEY SOOT
- ☐ The true count: twenty men
- ☐ Six are Ironwake's, not Vaskar's
- ☐ The masked one is branded — a Penitent
- ☐ ...and the first Dol team's only survivor
- ☐ Cobb kept the ledger · is being tortured for it
- ☐ Durgan can switch Mott off
- ☐ What Vaskar is (Corvant's account)
- ☐ The hooded buyers took all the women
- ☐ Denrick sold the tunnel and trapped it

known in S1

known in S1

YSABEL'S FIVE — WHAT THEY'VE BEEN TOLD TO DO

No job = they break the moment one of them drops.

Perrin Aske

Dov Brandt

Symon Reeve

Cael Ordway

Mina Dorn

RESOURCES — no long rest tonight

	HP	SLOTS	OTHER
JonLief			
Wolfram			
Virgil			
Luthien			
Gimble			

Wolfram's Lay on Hands: / 15 — does NOT come back tonight

SHORT RESTS TAKEN (1 hr each — off the clock)

FLAGS

state, not knowledge

- ☐ Cover still intact
- ☐ Vaskar met — he has counted them
- ☐ Anselm has SEEN Wolfram
- ☐ Anselm SPOKEN to
- ☐ Denrick talked to · believed?
- ☐ Deep Cages entered
- ☐ Durgan spoken to · kindness shown to Mott
- ☐ Gimble freed / unmasked
- ☐ Cobb reached ALIVE
- ☐ Working ledger taken from the office
- ☐ Armory opened
- ☐ Talwyn Ceth freed (the ledger backup)
- ☐ Second ledger STILL WITH THE PARTY
- ☐ Revolt has fired

YSABEL IS DETAINED ONLY IF ALL THREE

- ☐ The match happened
- ☐ Revolt put down, or never fired
- ☐ Party never engaged Vaskar

Break any ONE and she walks.

MOTT — decides the TRIAL, not the match

- ☐ Still Ironwake's champion
- ☐ Dead
- ☐ Hurt — can't fight in two days
- ☐ Gone with Durgan

GUARDS DOWN

FEN ×14

IRONWAKE ×6

NEVER MORE THAN 5 ACTING IN A ROUND.

NOTES

The yard, walking in

5:30 · they are already here

The yard is muddy underfoot and the air sits heavy and humid and full of the smell of a great many unwashed people who are frightened all of the time. Guards shouting across each other. Hammering from the middle of the yard. And under it, a low sound that takes a moment to identify as a man.

Then: the drunk guard at the post, and the escort saying not to trouble themselves — he's a half-orc, they take a beating.

The whipping post

Marek Osu is the one taking it

The guard is drunk and he is not very good at this, which is somehow worse. He is taking his time because he keeps losing his place. Three men are on their knees in the mud with their heads held up so they have to watch. One of them has stopped watching. He is looking at you.

Then: the cover costs something to keep. Let them not intervene, and let that sit.

The Chainmaster's Hall — Vaskar receives them

~6:00 · Cobb is in this building

He does not get up, and he is not rude about it. He looks at Lady Ysabel the way a man looks at a column of figures that has come out right. 'My lady. You'll forgive the state of the place — we have a guest of Lord Ironwake's and the whole fen has lost its head over it.' A pause, exactly long enough. 'You've brought rather a lot of people to look at cloth-hands.'

Then: ten minutes of courteous lying. He is counting them. Somewhere behind a door there is a chair leg, or a cough, or breathing that isn't one of theirs.

Old Cobb

gone at 7:45 if nobody reaches him

The old man in the chair does not look up when the door opens. He has learned what it means when the door opens. His hands are wrong. When he finally does lift his head, one eye is swollen closed and the other is trying very hard to focus on you, and what comes out of him is not a plea. It's a professional's habit, forty years deep: 'I've told him. The record would indicate — there is no record. There's no record left to give him.'

He is telling the truth. He gave the book away and does not know where it went. Vaskar cannot tell the difference between a man protecting a secret and a man who has none.

The Pens — JonLief's scene

give him the room, slow it down

Stone, and dark, and forty years of men. They come to the bars when they hear the door — not fast. Nobody in here moves fast. Someone asks if you're the buyer. Someone else tells him to shut up. And then, from the back, where it's darkest, an old voice that has clearly asked this before and stopped expecting an answer: 'Is there anyone out there still looking for us?'

Then: nobody here knows about the woman and the boy. Make him ask five times. Empty cell at the end, Investigation DC 12 → the hollow under the flagstone, and the dust disturbed within the month.

Anselm knows him

near-miss FIRST, then the real thing

The old man at the back of the cage has not moved since you came in. Now he stands, and he takes his time about it, and he looks at you the way a man looks at a debt he never expected to collect. 'Eisenherz,' he says. Not a question. 'I gave a statement about you to a clerk in the Citadel. He never wrote it down.'

NO Insight roll — tell the table plainly this man is telling the truth. Then he gives the true count: twenty. Fourteen and six. Then he asks Wolfram: 'Who's in charge of you?'

The Deep Cages

1 Fen Guard outside · 2 Ironwake inside

Two cells. In the first, a dwarf sits with his back to the bars, watching. In the second — and it takes a moment to understand the scale of what you are seeing — a man the size of a cart horse is sitting cross-legged in the straw, holding a bundle of twine and stalks in the shape of a doll, and he is walking it very carefully along his own knee.

Durgan speaks first, and it's a warning: 'Don't shout. He's having a good day.'

The masked one

the reveal is the SHOULDER, not the face

The second cell holds something much smaller. It is sitting cross-legged in the exact centre of the floor, in rags, with a riveted iron mask over the whole of its head, and it is not asleep — it is facing the door, and it was facing the door before you opened it. It does not move when the light hits it. One of the guards behind you laughs and says something about not bothering to learn its name.

Rags, one bare shoulder, a sun with a single tear. Let a PC find it. The moment they see it, the cover is over — and that is a good way for it to end.

Sundown — the ring

8:00 · Anselm's signal lands here

They've dragged the fence into a circle in the middle of the yard, and every man in Bramblefen who isn't chained is leaning on it. The masked man is walked out. He doesn't struggle. He doesn't look at anyone. And then the doors of the Deep Cages open, and the crowd makes a sound you've heard before at fairs and hangings, and the ground moves.

Sequence the minute: match starts → Anselm signals → the yard goes up → THEN the outcome and Ysabel. One at a time, and let the party act between each.

THE EIGHTEEN

9 Term (human) · 9 Stock (non-human)

1	Anselm Vogt	TERM	Pens	Westfield sheriff. Leader. Knows Wolfram's crest.
2	Haskel Mundt	TERM	Pens	Smith, huge hands, forty words a day. Anselm's second.
3	Bertie Kranz	TERM	Pens	22, loud, aches to fight. Anselm fears losing him.
4	Corvant Hale	TERM	Pens	Sellsword. Tried this a year ago. WATCHED VASKAR KILL FOUR MEN.
5	Ondrej Fisk	TERM	Pens	Fen fisherman. Knows the water.
6	Rusk	TERM	Pens	No surname, no speech. Does not understand 'free.'
7	Mirek Vole	TERM	Post	Farmer. Weeps quietly and constantly.
8	Wendel Crook	TERM	Post	Was a guard here until 8 weeks ago. The moral bill.
9	Ivo Lantz	TERM	Post	16. His dead father's debt. Under the lash.
10	Talwyn Ceth	STOCK	Pens	Scribe. CAN COPY A LEDGER FROM MEMORY — protect him.
11	Kesh Vanner	STOCK	Auction	Navigator, 40 yrs at sea. Remembers buyers asking for artists.
12	Yarel Stoke	STOCK	Pens	Pit fighter. Count him as three men. Wants Vaskar.
13	Marek Osu	STOCK	Post	Temple servant. Still prays — to Azerai.
14	Sabbath Ivry	STOCK	Auction	19, tiefling. Branded twice. Furious, reckless.
15	Tobrun Ashfoot	STOCK	Auction	Halfling housebreaker. Opens most things with a bent nail.
16	Bosk Dunmar	STOCK	Pens	Dwarf mason. Built two of these walls as a free man.
17	Nim Tarrow	STOCK	Pens	Gnome tinker. Deaf one ear — will miss a whispered signal.
18	Ghesh Saltscale	STOCK	Pens	Lizardfolk, fen-born. Everyone keeps a space around him.

DEATHS, IN THIS ORDER — guards go for the slow, the small, the already bleeding

Ivo → Mirek → Nim → Sabbath → Rusk → Bertie → Marek → Ondrej → Bosk → Wendel → Kesh → Tobrun → Ghesh → Talwyn → Corvant → Yarel → Haskel → Anselm

YSABEL'S FIVE — inside the wall with the party

Perrin Aske	54	Steward. Won't run. Won't leave without Ysabel.
Dov Brandt	31	HER PROPERTY — Terms, 3 yrs left. Sold on this block. Remembers Cobb.
Symon Reeve	26	Driver. The carts — how 18 freed men leave the fen.
Cael Ordway	18	Terrified. If you need one death to land, it's him.
Mina Dorn	40s	Lady-in-waiting. Bandages. Kind to Erwana unprompted.

AC 13 · HP 9 · shortsword +2 (1d6). One drops and the rest break, unless a PC gave them a job.

VOICES — one line each

Vaskar	Calm, courteous, transactional. Prices everything. Never raises his voice, never rages, never dies for Ironwake.
Old Cobb	Precise, hedging, clerkish. 'The record would indicate.' Qualifies everything, even now. Needs to confess.
Denrick	Ingratiating, twitchy. 'Friend.' 'Of course.' Smooth on big lies, fumbles small details. Insight DC 13.
Anselm	Slow, level, unhurried. Says a thing once. Produces an exact number mid-scene. Never pleads.
Durgan	Low, economical, dry. A rare joke means he's decided you're safe. Folds instantly if Mott is threatened.
Mott	Few words, child's cadence. Names things he likes. The straw doll. Never raises a hand to Durgan.
Ysabel	Fraying nobility. On slavery: bewildered, then the Church, then cold. Never cruel, never converted by one roll.